A-A-20186
June 28, 1991

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

LOBSTER TAIL, SPINY, RAW, FROZEN

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description in preference to Military Specification MIL-L-44190.

This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers spiny lobster tail, packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by the Federal Government.

Salient characteristics.

The spiny lobster tail shall be from spiny lobsters of the Family Palinuridae, Genus Panulirus, species (a) argus, (b) interruptus, or (c) marginatus. The spiny lobster tails shall be handled and processed in accordance with Title 50, Code of Federal Regulations, Chapter II, Parts 260.97 through 260.104. For species P. argus and P. interruptus, processing shall be from live lobsters. For species P. marginatus, processing shall be from frozen, raw lobsters only.

The product shall conform to the following net weight ranges:

Net weight ranges.

Net weight range I - 4 to 10 ounces
Net weight range II - 5 to 8 ounces

Individual tails shall not be split to meet the net weight requirement. The flesh shall be translucent (snow white), untainted by dark spots, and shall not have an opaque gray color. The product shall not have soft shell and shall be free from shell fragments and viscera. There shall be no evidence of tail damage (cuts or scars penetrating the shell or crushed shell). There shall be no evidence of dehydration, thawing, refreezing, or glazing. There shall be no foreign color or foreign odors such as, but not limited to, ammonial, putrid, or spoiled. The product shall be free from foreign material, such as, but not limited to, glass, paint, metal, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, or paper.

The spiny lobster tails shall be individually placed in polyethylene bags, placed in a freezer (maintained at 0°F or less) within 2 hours of packaging, and frozen to an internal temperature of 0°F or less within 24 hours.

FSC 8905

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

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Contractor's certification.

By submitting an offer, the contractor certifies that the product offered meets the specified salient characteristics and requirements of this CID; conforms to the producer's own specifications and standards, including product characteristics, manufacturing procedures, quality control procedures, and storage and handling practices; has a national or regional distribution from storage facilities located within the United States, its territories, or possessions; and is sold on the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to determine proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery from point of origin and any time thereafter, up to and including delivery at final destination, as may be necessary to determine conformance with the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

The delivered product shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sales of the product in the commercial marketplace. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder. All products shall also meet with the provisions of Regulations Governing Processed Fishery Products, Processed Products Thereof, and Certain Other Processed Fishery Products, Inspection and Certification, 50 CFR, Subchapter G, Part 260.

Quality assurance.

Compliance with this CID shall be determined by the U.S. Department of Commerce (USDC), National Marine Fisheries Service (NMFS). In accordance with USDC policies and procedures, the local NMFS supervisor will determine the degree of inspection and supervision necessary to assure specification compliance. The cost of all services performed by NMFS agents involving examination, supervision, official documentation, and related services shall be borne by the contractor.

The lobster tails shall be inspected by the USDC, NMFS, under Type I continuous inspection and in accordance with this CID.

Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The lot size shall be as indicated by the sampling plan specified in Table I, and the lobster tails shall be inspected for the defects listed in Table II.

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Table I. Sampling plan for product examination

Lot size (pounds)	Sample size (lobster tails)		Major		Minor	
	Major	Minor	Ac	Re	Ac	Re
0 - 500	8	8	0	1	1	2
501 - 3,200	8	13	0	1	2	3
3,201 - 10,000	32	20	1	2	3	4
10,001 - 35,000	32	32	1	2	5	6

The sample unit for USDC Inspection is the contents of one bag. For sampling purposes, a lot shall be defined as lobster tails produced during a single 8-hour production shift at one plant location from the same batch of raw material which is homogeneous with respect to catch and subsequent handling conditions.

The contractor shall obtain a USDC Certificate of Inspection which state(s) the product meets all requirements of this CID.

Table II. Product and packaging defects 1/ 2/

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
101		Evidence of tail damage (cuts or scars penetrating the shell or crushed shell).
102		Evidence of soft shell.
103		Evidence of dehydration, thawing, refreezing, or glazing.
104		Lobster tails not packaged and intermediate packed as specified.
105		The weight of sample unit not as specified.
	201	Presence of shell fragments or viscera.

1/ The finding of incorrect species shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ The presence of foreign material (for example, glass, paint, metal, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood) foreign odor or flavor (for example, ammonial, putrid, spoiled) or foreign color (for example, opaque or gray) shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

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Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking.

The lobster tails shall be preserved, packaged, packed, labeled, and case marked in accordance with good commercial practice. Commercial labeling and packaging, as may be augmented by the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, shall be acceptable. Shipping containers shall comply with the National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable.

For Department of Defense procurements (Only).

The following requirements are applicable when specified by the contracting officer.

Purchasers should specify net weight range II.

A. Commercial packaging. Each lobster tail shall be packaged in a polyethylene bag of sufficient length to allow a folding closure. Ten pounds of bagged lobster tails shall be packed and frozen in an intermediate paperboard or fiberboard container in accordance with good commercial practice. Glazing shall be prohibited.

B. Commercial packing. Not more than 40 pounds of commercially packaged product shall be packed in a snug-fitting, fiberboard box complying with the National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable, except metal fasteners shall not be used in the final closure of the box.

C. Export packaging. Each lobster tail shall be packaged in a minimum 0.004 inch thick polyethylene bag and shall have a fold-over or heat sealed closure. Ten pounds of bagged lobster tails shall be packed and frozen in an intermediate paperboard or fiberboard container in accordance with good commercial practice. Glazing shall be prohibited.

D. Export packing. Not more than 40 pounds of product shall be packed in a snug-fitting, fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with Style RSC, Grade V3c, V3s, or V4s of PPP-B-636. Alternatively, the shipping container shall be a wax-impregnated, fiberboard box, constructed in accordance with Style RSC or FTC, Class I, SWCFI, Grade 200 of PPP-B-1163. Closure of RSC boxes shall be with hot melt adhesive in accordance with the Appendix of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive, filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the Appendix of PPP-B-636.

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E. Unit loads (commercial and export). Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078. When unit loads are strapped, strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for Type II, Class F loads.

F. Labeling (commercial and export). Commercial labeling shall be acceptable.

G. Marking (commercial and export). Marking of shipping containers and unit loads shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129. In addition, the following markings shall appear on the top of the shipping containers in letters between 1 and 1-1/2 inches high, all letters being the same height:

KEEP FROZEN (0°F OR BELOW)

Notes.

Purchasers should specify net weight range.

Sources of documents:

Sources of information for nongovernmental documents are as follows:

Copies of the National Motor Freight Classification may be obtained from:

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent
National Motor Freight Classification
American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department
2200 Mill Road
Alexandria, VA 22314

Copies of the Uniform Freight Classification may be obtained from:

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent
Uniform Freight Classification
Uniform Classification Committee, Suite 1120
222 South Riverside Plaza
Chicago, IL 60606

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Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1-199. This three-volume set may be purchased from:

Superintendent of Documents
U.S. Government Printing Office
Washington, DC 20402-0001

Credit card (Master Charge or Visa) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents on (202) 783-3238.

Copies of the Regulations Governing Processed Fishery Products are available from:

National Marine Fisheries Service
Office of Trade and Industry Services
Inspection Services Division
1335 East-West Highway
Silver Springs, MD 20910

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from:

General Services Administration
Specifications Unit (3FB-WS)
Room 6654
7th and D Streets, SW
Washington, DC 20407

Military activities should submit requests for copies of this CID to:

Standardization Documents Order Desk
Building 4D
700 Robbins Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094

Comments and suggestions.

Comments and suggestions regarding this CID should be submitted to:

U.S. Army Natick Research,
Development and Engineering Center
ATTN: STRNC-WTP
Natick, MA 01760-5018

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MILITARY INTERESTS:

Military Coordinating Activity

Army - GL

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review Activities

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC
DP - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - FDA, NIH
USDA - FV
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

Army - GL

(Project 8905-1095)

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